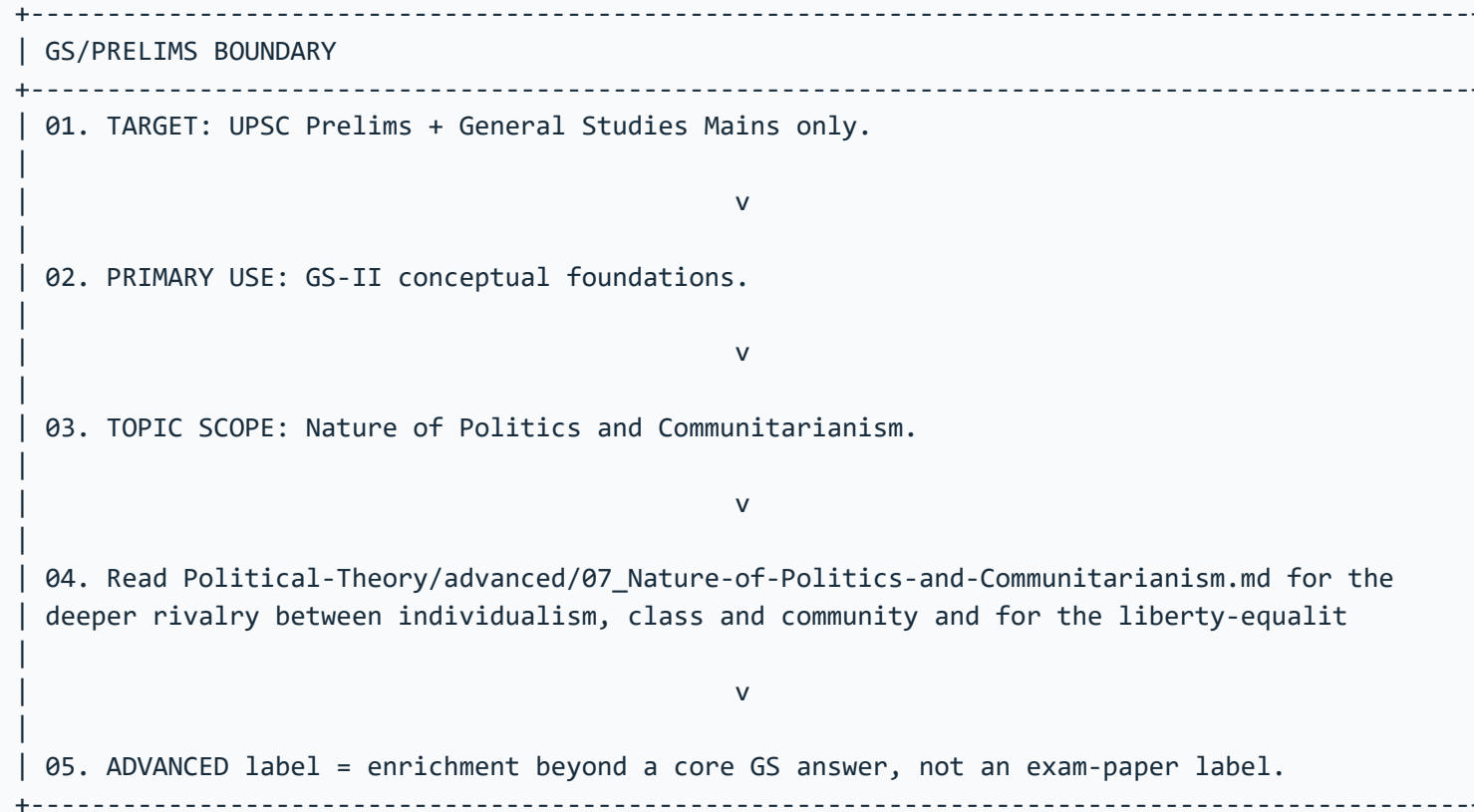


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/16: GS/Prelims Boundary

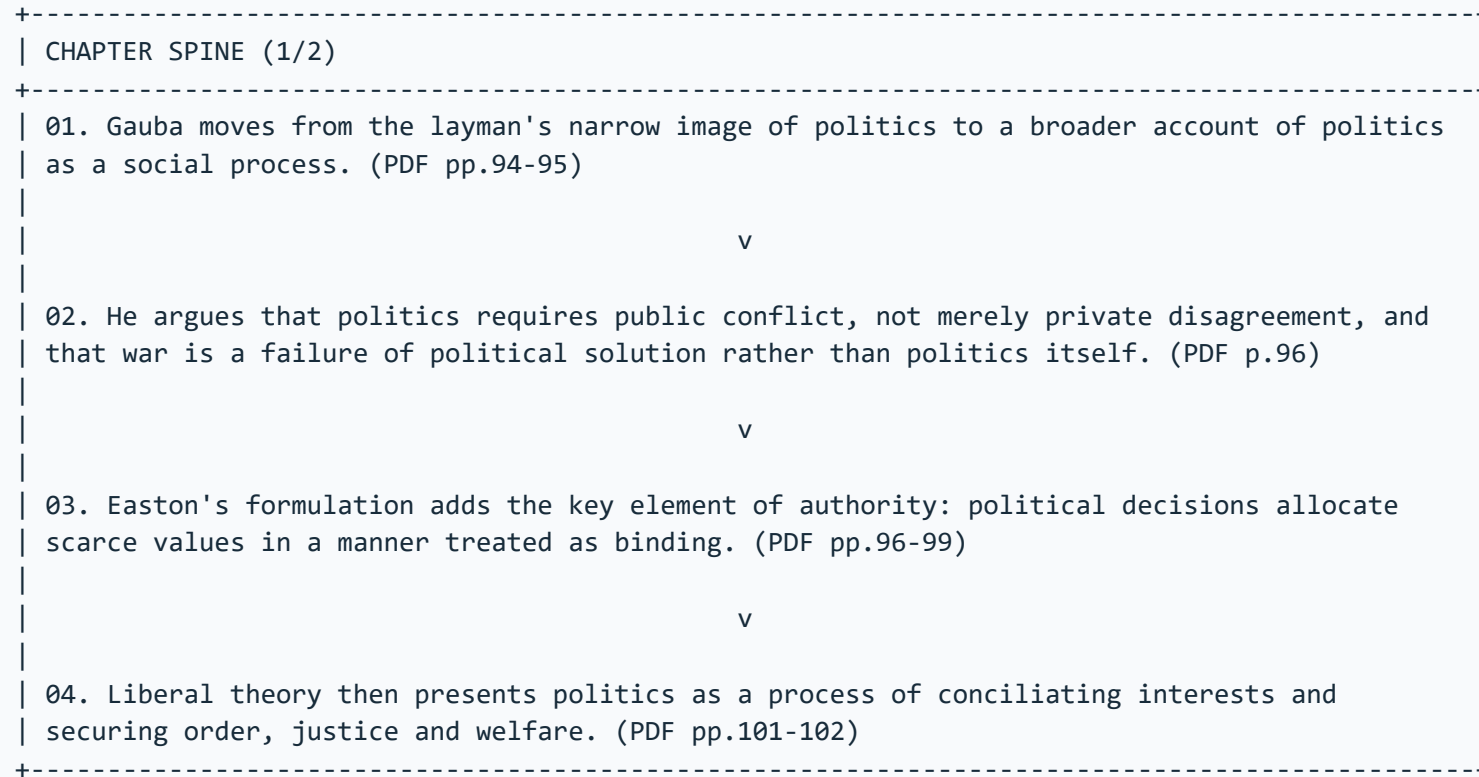


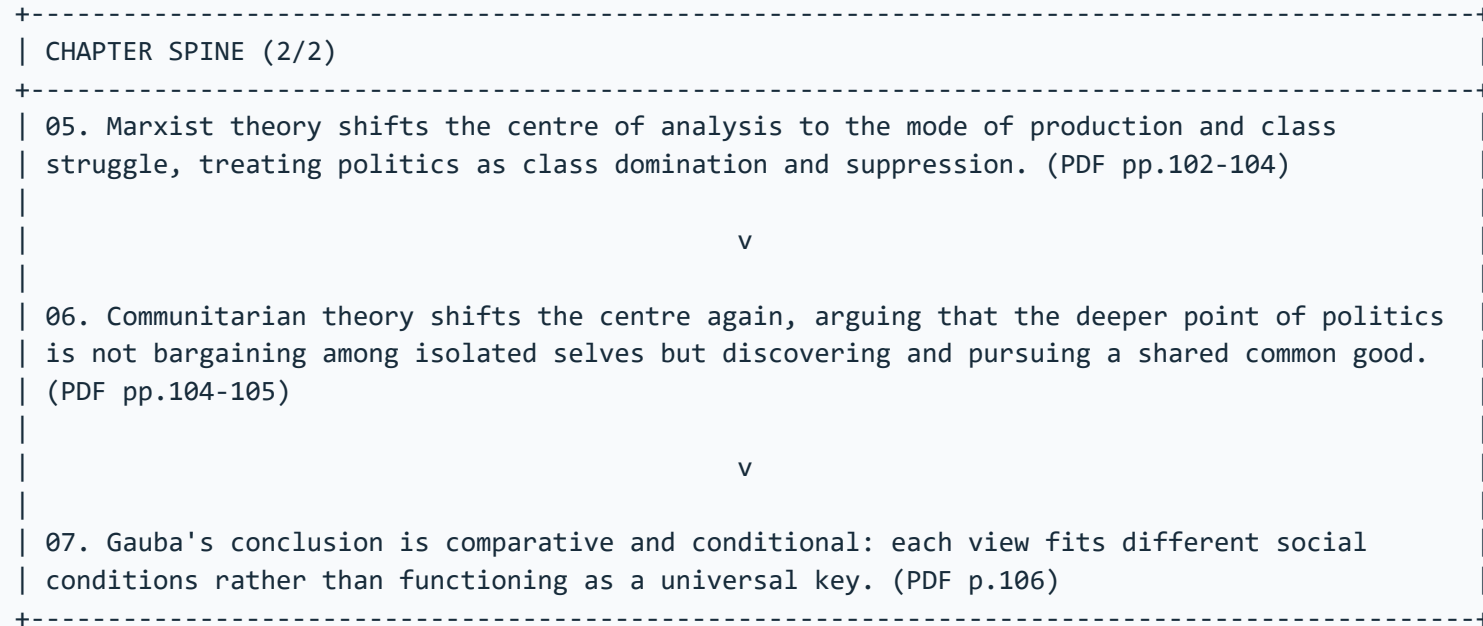
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/16: Origin and Dated Rail

+-----+ ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL +-----+		
01. 1632-1704 -> John Locke		
	v	
02. 1818-83 -> Karl Marx		
	v	
03. 1820-95 -> Friedrich Engels		
	v	
04. 1848 -> As Marx and Engels in their Communist Manifesto		
	v	
05. 1949 -> People's Republic of China		
	v	
06. 1977 -> Ralph Miliband, in his Marxism and Politics		
	v	
07. 1988 -> Alan Ball, in his Modern Politics and Government		
+-----+		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/16: Core Definitions

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+-----+
| CORE DEFINITIONS                                     |
+-----+
| 01. POLITICS: A public process involving conflict, its resolution, and authoritative value- |
| allocation in society. (PDF pp.95-99)                |
| 02. POLITICAL SITUATION: A situation of public conflict among major groups that calls for a |
| universal/public solution, not a private settlement. (PDF p.96)                |
| 03. AUTHORITATIVE ALLOCATION OF VALUES: Easton's idea that politics distributes valued |
| things through decisions treated as binding because they carry authority, not mere brute |
| force. (PDF pp.96-97)                                |
| 04. LIBERAL VIEW OF POLITICS: Politics as group-and-state activity aimed at reconciling |
| competing interests and promoting a common good compatible with them. (PDF pp.101-102) |
| 05. MARXIST VIEW OF POLITICS: Politics as an effect of class division, used by the dominant |
| class to hold down the dependent class until class society is abolished. (PDF pp.102-104) |
| 06. COMMUNITARIANISM: A view stressing that persons are socially constituted, owe duties to |
| the community, and should seek their good through the good of the community. (PDF pp.101, |
| 104-105)                                             |
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/16: Thinkers and Named Positions (1)

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+-----+
| THINKERS AND NAMED POSITIONS (1) |
+-----+
| 01. ARISTOTLE: Politics begins with the polis, and communitarian strands later revive his |
| idea that political association is tied to good life. (PDF pp.95, 104) |
| 02. DAVID EASTON: Politics is the authoritative allocation of values for society. (PDF |
| pp.96-97) |
| 03. LIBERAL-PLURALIST STREAM: Locke-linked liberalism treats society as composed of multiple |
| organized groups seeking accommodation through the state. (PDF pp.100-102) |
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/16: Thinkers and Named Positions (2)

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+-----+
| THINKERS AND NAMED POSITIONS (2) |
+-----+
| 01. MARX AND ENGELS: Politics and the state arise from class division and serve dominant- |
| class interests until class conflict ends in a classless order. (PDF pp.102-104) |
| 02. MACINTYRE, TAYLOR, SANDEL: Contemporary communitarians criticize the atomistic |
| individual and stress embedded identity, virtue, shared understanding and common good. (PDF |
| pp.101, 105) |
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/16: Illustrations Attached to Claims

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| ILLUSTRATIONS ATTACHED TO CLAIMS |
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| 01. Reserved seats, taxation and similar distributive arrangements show how authoritative |
| allocation binds both beneficiaries and contributors. (PDF p.99) |
| 02. The queue system or traffic-signal type example captures the liberal hope that |
| institutional rules can reconcile competing claims. (PDF p.102) |
| 03. Marxist analysis would treat labour-capital compromise in class society as unstable |
| because the underlying relation of dominance remains intact. (PDF pp.103-106) |
| 04. Communitarian analysis would read family breakdown, loneliness, crime or drug abuse in |
| modern liberal society as signs of weakened social bonds. (PDF pp.101, 105) |
| 05. In answers, use such examples as conceptual illustrations, not as present-day data |
| claims |
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/16: Comparison Matrix

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COMPARISON MATRIX	
+-----+	
01. IMAGE OF SOCIETY Liberal view = A plurality of individuals and groups with	
reconcilable interests. (PDF pp.101-102) Marxist view = Antagonistic classes structured by	
ownership and exploitation. (PDF pp.102-104) Communitarian view = Interconnected persons	
whose identity is formed within community. (PDF pp.101, 104-105)	
02. NATURE OF POLITICS Liberal view = Reconciliation and authoritative settlement of	
disputes. (PDF pp.101-102) Marxist view = Suppression/management of class conflict under	
class rule. (PDF pp.103-104) Communitarian view = Identification and pursuit of the common	
good. (PDF pp.104-105)	
03. COMMON GOOD Liberal view = A balanced outcome accommodating contending interests. (PDF	
p.102) Marxist view = Not genuinely available under class society dominated by class	
interests. (PDF p.107) Communitarian view = A shared good comprehending the interest of	
each member. (PDF p.107)	
04. ORGANIZING IDEAL Liberal view = Liberty. (PDF p.107) Marxist view = Equality. (PDF	
p.107) Communitarian view = Fraternity. (PDF p.107)	
05. END-POINT Liberal view = Order, justice and welfare within society. (PDF p.102)	
Marxist view = Classless society where politics withers away. (PDF pp.104, 107)	
Communitarian view = Social solidarity through cooperation and belonging. (PDF pp.104-107)	
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/16: Examiner Trap Firewall

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| EXAMINER TRAP FIREWALL |
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| 01. TRAP: Politics means only party competition or elections => REPAIR: Gauba widens |
| politics to public conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99) |
| 02. TRAP: Any quarrel becomes political => REPAIR: Only public conflicts requiring a |
| universal/public solution count as properly political. (PDF p.96) |
| 03. TRAP: Communitarianism means total unanimity or denial of all real tensions => REPAIR: |
| Gauba presents it as a stress on common interest and cooperation, but he also says it |
| becomes futile where wide disparities of power and opinion persist. (PDF pp.106-107) |
| 04. TRAP: Marxism treats every visible compromise as genuine reconciliation => REPAIR: |
| Marxist analysis treats such compromise as often imposed within relations of domination. |
| (PDF pp.103-106) |
| 05. TRAP: Liberalism ignores common good altogether => REPAIR: In Gauba, liberalism does |
| speak of a common good, but as something worked out through accommodation of interests. (PDF |
| p.102) |
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/16: Ownership Boundaries and Cross-Links

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| OWNERSHIP BOUNDARIES AND CROSS-LINKS |
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| 01. Read Political-Theory/advanced/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md for the |
| deeper rivalry between individualism, class and community and for the liberty-equality- |
| fraternity matrix |
| 02. Read Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md to |
| see how different approaches study politics once its nature is defined |
| 03. Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the larger comparison between liberal, |
| Marxist and communitarian conceptual families |
| 04. Use Political-Theory/README.md for the full topic map and dated-source discipline |
| 05. Boundary: this file stays at the conceptual level and does not duplicate constitutional |
| Polity material |
+-----+
```

REVISION CAPSULE

01. Politics, for Gauba, is a public process of conflict and authoritative resolution, not a synonym for private quarrelling or war. (PDF pp.95-99)

V

| 02. Liberalism: many groups, limited conflict, reconciliation, common good, welfare |
| orientation. (PDF pp.101-102) |

V

03. Marxism: economic structure, class antagonism, dominant-class state, politics as suppression until classless society. (PDF pp.102-104)

V

| 04. Communitarianism: embedded self, duties, cooperation, common good, fraternity. (PDF |
| pp.101, 104-107) |

V

05. Best UPSC line: politics can be read as reconciliation, domination, or common-good pursuit depending on whether society is imagined as plural individuals, classes, or community

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/16: Answer-Grabbing Line Bank

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE BANK	
+-----+	
01. Politics is not just elections or party intrigue; it is a public process around	
conflict, decision and order. (PDF pp.95-99)	
02. Term - Exam-ready meaning	
03. Thinker / stream - Position in this chapter	
04. Reserved seats, taxation and similar distributive arrangements show how authoritative	
allocation binds both beneficiaries and contributors. (PDF p.99)	
05. Politics means only party competition or elections. -> Gauba widens politics to public	
conflict-resolution and authoritative value-allocation. (PDF pp.95-99)	
06. Gauba names MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel together as communitarian critics of the	
atomistic liberal self (PDF pp.101, 105), but a strong answer must not treat them as one	
undifferentiated	
07. 2. Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition (Sources of the Self, 1989; "The	
Politics of Recognition", 1994)	
08. Use both names only as precursors/anticipations, not card-carrying communitarians -	
overstating this lineage is a taxonomic overclaim to avoid	
09. 1. Objection (communitarian -> liberal): liberal neutrality (the state should not favour	
any particular conception of the good life) is impossible and self-defeating - liberal	
politics	
10. "Explain/Discuss the nature of politics" -> definitional + comparative directive: define	
the political situation (Easton/Gauba), then compare at least two rival images of society	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/16: Must-Write Keyword Bank

+-----+	
MUST-WRITE KEYWORD BANK	
+-----+	
01. Subject;; Tier;; Exam relevance;; Core area;; Grounded in;; Source edition/cutoff;;	
Politics	
02. Definitions; Chapter Spine; Essential Distinctions; SESSION; Essential; Term; Exam-ready	
03. Thinkers; Positions; Three Rival; Social Images; SESSION; Thinker; Position	
04. Illustrations; Liberty-Equality-Fraternity Matrix; SESSION; Illustrative; Reserved;	
Marxist; Communitarian	
05. Trap Repair; Boundaries; Revision; Source Discipline; SESSION; UPSC; Politics	
06. Alasdair MacIntyre - tradition and practices; Claim;; Evidence/mechanism;;	
Significance;; Limit;; MacIntyre; Traditions	
07. Charles Taylor - dialogical self and recognition; Claim;; Evidence/mechanism;;	
Significance;; Limit;; Taylor; Dialogical Identity	
08. Michael Sandel - critique of the unencumbered self; Claim;; Evidence/mechanism;;	
Significance;; Limit;; Exam discipline;; Sandel	
09. Objection (communitarian -> liberal);; Reply (liberal);; Objection (communitarian ->	
liberal, Sandel's core charge);; Reply (liberal, standard rebuttal);; Communitarian	
Objections; Liberal Replies; Indian Application	
10. Directive Decoding; Mark-Scaled Answer; Architecture; SESSION; Executable; Directive;	
Explain	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/16: GS Mains Question Routes

+-----+	
GS MAINS QUESTION ROUTES	
+-----+	
01. 10 MARKS: Define a political situation and explain why authority, rather than brute	
force, is central to Easton's account of politics. Answer in 150 words	
02. 10 MARKS: Distinguish the liberal, Marxist and communitarian views of politics. Answer	
in 150 words	
03. 10 MARKS: Examine the communitarian critique of the atomistic liberal self with	
reference to MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel. Answer in 150 words	
04. 15 MARKS: Is liberal neutrality possible? Discuss the communitarian objection and the	
liberal reply. Answer in 250 words	
05. 15 MARKS: Is politics best understood as reconciliation, class domination or pursuit of	
the common good? Critically discuss. Answer in 250 words	
06. 15 MARKS: Evaluate communitarianism as an alternative to liberalism, with reference to	
embedded selfhood, the common good and its limits. Answer in 250 words	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/16: Qualified Verdict and Answer Spine

QUALIFIED VERDICT AND ANSWER SPINE	
01. Open with the boundary line, not with a general definition.	v
02. Carry the argument on named evidence taken from the thinker panels.	v
03. Insert the trap-firewall distinction that the question is testing.	v
04. Add the objection or limitation before concluding.	v
05. CLOSE: Best UPSC line: politics can be read as reconciliation, domination, or common-good pursuit depending on whether society is imagined as plural individuals, classes, or community. Use both names only as precursors/anticipations, not card-carrying communitarians - overstating this lineage is a taxonomic overclaim to avoid. So the answer must move from definition to mechanism to counter-position, and end with a verdict that concedes what the evidence cannot support	